

## MODULE 1

# HOW CRITICISM AND BIAS INFLUENCE HISTORICAL UNDERSTANDING

Etymologically, History is derived from the Ancient Greek (historía) 'inquiry, that means knowledge acquired by investigation. History is the study of discipline in chronological past events as it changes over years, and it all tackles the aspects of Human society. Political, social, economic, scientific, technological, medical, cultural, intellectual, religious and military developments are also branches of history.

Herodotus, an Ancient Greek Philosopher is the Father of History. He is one of the many historians that is significant in history as he was recognized to be the first to write a comprehensive and systematic account of human affairs. Herodotus spent his life working on the well known masterpiece "The Histories", much of his work is related to events before wars, focusing on events that occurred between 550 BC and 490 BC. After he died, editors designated his book into nine (9), each book containing various origins, conflicts of battles and aftermaths. Herodotus was not the first to write Greco-Persian Wars, but he was the first to provide the comprehensive and systematic parts of the events, making him considered as the 'Father of History'.

History is like a jigsaw puzzle, just like a puzzle, it is made of different parts or pieces that you need to combine together to create a structured-accurate picture. Same with History, it is needed to put the information together to get the accurate picture of the events. Historical knowledge is also limited, just as jigsaw puzzles might be missing some piece, historical records can be damaged, lost, or never even created. Such events and experiences in the past are not documented, and what we know about history often comes from the evidence we can find, such as books, letters, or artifacts. But these pieces of evidence don't always tell the full story. Aside from that, various historians may look at the same pieces of evidence and come to different conclusions about what happened. The way people view the past comes differently based on their own perspectives and interpretations.

There are theories constructed by historians when it comes to investigating theories; ***Factual History and Speculative History.***

1. **Factual History** - The factual history relies on verifiable evidence. It relies on tangible sources such as documents, records, artifacts, and testimonies that can be verified through research and factual analysis. It aims to provide accurate information focusing on facts and first-hand information rather than assumptions.
2. **Speculative History** - The speculative history is making guesses and hypothesizing about past events that is still not proven. It often fills the gaps of events that are still missing and unclear. Historians or researchers might suggest "What might have happened" based on their knowledge which cannot be considered an absolute truth.

## LEARNING ACTIVITIES

**ACTIVITY 1:** Let us see the depth of knowledge you have for this lesson. Identify the statements, write **F** if the statement is Factual History, and **S** if its Speculative History in the given space before the number.

- \_\_\_ 1. Who was the first President of the Philippines?
- \_\_\_ 2. Did the Philippines fight against Japan during the World War II?
- \_\_\_ 3. What would the Philippines look like if the EDSA People Power Revolution had failed during the reign of President Ferdinand Marcos Sr.?
- \_\_\_ 4. How would the Philippines would have been different if they weren't colonized by United States after Spain?
- \_\_\_ 5. How might Philippine History changed if the Spanish did not colonized the Philippines?

In continuity. In history, Historians use sources to understand and construct the past all together. Here are the 3 main categories of resources used in History: **Primary, Secondary, Tertiary Source.**

1. **Primary Source** - It is considered the original, first-hand accounts, and evidence of an event being studied. This source provides factual and immediate "raw material", such as fragments, shards, fossils etc. that historians collect for a reliable understanding of an event that occurred from the past.

**Examples of Primary Sources are:** *personal journals/diaries/memoirs, letters, court proceedings, legislative debates, newspaper, paintings, speech field research etc.*

2. **Secondary Source** - These are the interpretations and analyses based on primary sources, these are arguments/interpretations about the past and are built upon a foundation of historical evidence. Secondary sources help how historians or scholars interpret past events.

**Examples of Secondary Sources are:** *bibliography annotation, biography, literature reviews etc, documentaries, reviews.*

3. **Tertiary Source** - these are compilations of the Primary and Secondary Sources and are typically used for deeper overviews or to locate more detailed primary and secondary sources.

**Examples of Tertiary Sources are:** *dictionaries, almanacs, archive, museum, library etc.*

## LEARNING ACTIVITY

**ACTIVITY 2: Identifying Sources!** Read the statements carefully, write **T** if the statement is True, **F** if the statement is False based on if it describes Primary, Secondary or Tertiary Sources.

- \_\_\_ 1. A letter written by a soldier in World War II is a primary source.
- \_\_\_ 2. A dictionary which provides summaries of Historical events is tertiary source.
- \_\_\_ 3. A newspaper article analyzing the effect of Marawi, written years after the war is a primary source.
- \_\_\_ 4. A letter from President Marcos declaring Martial Law in 1972 is a secondary source.

## HISTORICAL CRITICISM AND ITS PARTS

Historical criticism is a literary analysis that researchers often consider comparing texts from different timelines and use the resources to come up with a greater understanding of how a specific information influenced the event. Historical criticism aims to gain a deeper understanding of history by critiquing or questioning the sources and considering the biases. These methods help historians assess the reliability, accuracy, and the meaning of a source:

1. **Internal Criticism** - Internal criticism is used to detect and determine if the document has errors, it focuses on the content and message of the historical source itself. It evaluates the credibility and accuracy of the information being used in the document and also considers the context which was created.
2. **External Criticism** - it is used to determine the validity of an information, it examines the authenticity and origin of the source. It asks questions about the origin and author, considering whether it is a reliable and valid piece of evidence.

## LEARNING ACTIVITY

**ACTIVITY 3: Critiquing!** Read the statements carefully write **T** if the statement is True, **F** if the statement is False based on if it describes Internal Criticism or External Criticism.

- \_\_\_ 1. External Criticism involves checking the physical form of a historical document, like verifying the age of a manuscript.
- \_\_\_ 2. Internal Criticism in the Philippine History would involve comparing different perspectives of the EDSA Revolution to determine which one is more accurate.
- \_\_\_ 3. When evaluating the authenticity of photographs taken during the Philippine-American War, external criticism involves determining whether the photos are original.
- \_\_\_ 4. Internal Criticism would examine the biases in a newspaper articles to assess the accuracy of the claims.

## **HISTORICAL BIAS**

Historians have their own liking, Historical bias refers to the personal influence or distortion that affects the interpretation and presentation of historical events. It happens when historians, writers, or people's sources present a partial version of history based on their personal beliefs, values, social context, and political views.

1. **Cultural Bias** - This occurs when people and historians interpret a certain situation based on their own belief and values.
2. **Gender Bias** - This occurs when historical accounts disregard the roles of women and cause stereotypical unequal light.
3. **Religion Bias** - It occurs when people write or teach history in a way other religions are viewed negatively because of their beliefs or practices.
4. **Racial Bias** - It occurs when societal judgment happens, it distorts and portrays racial groups a negative view justifying discrimination and inequality.
5. **Political Bias** - This occurs when historians or the people is influenced by political ideologies or the interest of the people in power.

## **LEARNING ACTIVITIES:**

### **ACTIVITY 4: HISTORICAL BIAS**

Identify the statements correctly and choose the correct answer in the provided choices below related with the types of Historical Bias.

1. In the Spanish colonization in the Philippines, the narrative often emphasizes the achievements of the Spanish. This is an example of?

- a) Political Bias
- b) Racial Bias
- c) Cultural Bias
- d) Religious Bias

2. A history textbook mostly focus on the accomplishments of male political leaders and neglects the contribution of women in the Philippine History, this is an example of?

- a) Gender Bias
- b) Racial Bias
- c) Political Bias
- d) Religious Bias

3. In a historical narrative about the Philippines transition to independence.

- a) Religious Bias
- b) Political Bias
- c) Cultural Bias
- d) Gender Bias

4. The religious effect of the Spanish Colonization, such as spreading Catholicism.

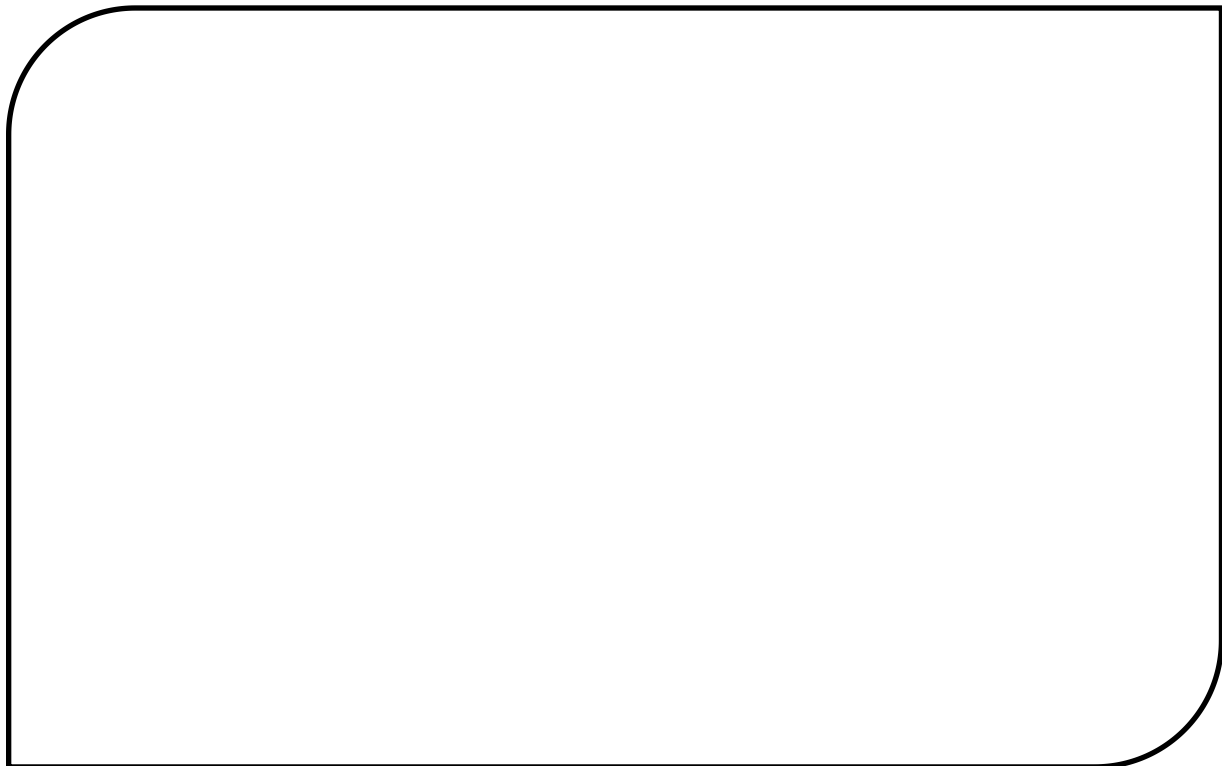
- a) Gender Bias
- b) Cultural Bias
- c) Religious Bias
- d) Cultural Bias

5. During the Spanish Colonization, some historical accounts portray Filipinos as lazy and resistance to change.

- a) Racial Bias
- b) Gender Bias
- c) Political Bias
- d) Religious Bias

**REFLECTION: PAUSE AND WONDER!**

Now, let's take a look at what you have learned in the previous discussion. Are you ready? If yes, **“Why is it important to consider multiple viewpoints in studying history?”**. Write not exceeding 80 words essay complying with the given task stated.



### FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT 1: THINK AND LINK!

**Directions:** Let us recall important points! Match column A with column B. Write your answer in the provided space before the number.

| <b>A</b>                   | <b>B</b>                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ___ 1. History             | <b>A.</b> Making guesses and hypothesizing about past events that is still not proven.                                             |
| ___ 2. Herodotus           | <b>B.</b> It focuses on the content and message of the historical source itself.                                                   |
| ___ 3. Factual History     | <b>C.</b> Relies on verifiable evidence.                                                                                           |
| ___ 4. Speculative History | <b>D.</b> These are compilations of the Primary and Secondary Sources and are typically used for deeper overview.                  |
| ___ 5. Primary Source      | <b>E.</b> It is considered the original, first-hand accounts, and evidence of an event being studied.                              |
| ___ 6. Secondary Source    | <b>F.</b> It refers to the personal influence or distortion that affects the interpretation and presentation of historical events. |
| ___ 7. Tertiary Source     | <b>G.</b> It occurs when people write or teach history in a way other religions are viewed negatively because of their belief.     |
| ___ 8. Internal Criticism  | <b>H.</b> These are the interpretations and analyses based on primary sources.                                                     |
| ___ 9. External Criticism  | <b>I.</b> This occurs when historians or the people is influenced by political ideologies or the interest of the people in power.  |
| ___ 10. Historical Bias    | <b>J.</b> This occurs when historical accounts disregard the roles of women and cause stereotypical.                               |
| ___ 11. Cultural Bias      | <b>K.</b> It occurs when societal judgment happens.                                                                                |
| ___ 12. Gender Bias        | <b>L.</b> Ancient Greek Philosopher is the Father of History.                                                                      |
| ___ 13. Religion Bias      | <b>M.</b> This occurs when people and historians interpret a certain situation based on their own belief and values.               |

|                        |                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ___ 14. Racial Bias    | <b>N.</b> Is the validity of an information, it examines the authenticity and origin of the source.           |
| ___ 15. Political Bias | <b>O.</b> Derived from the Ancient Greek (historía) 'inquiry, that means knowledge acquired by investigation, |

### **SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT**

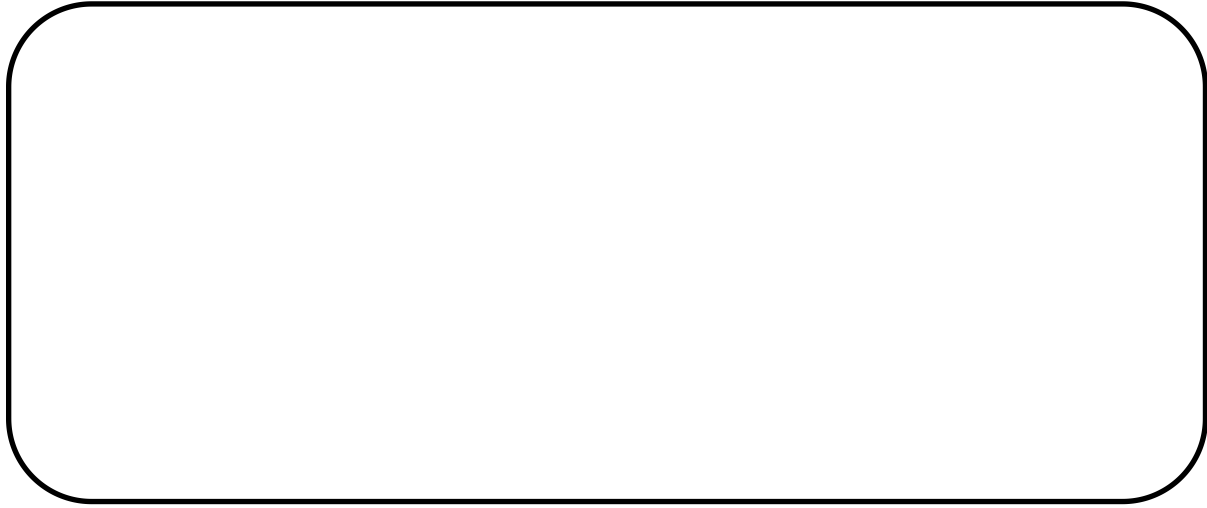
After answering the activities previously provided, you are now equipped with ideas ready for more challenging tasks!

### **REWRITING HISTORY**

**“How can Historians reduce Bias when writing about History? Why is it important to consider different perspectives when writing History?”.** Write *not exceeding 100 word* essay complying with this question provided.

### **REFLECTION QUESTION**

Reflect on this: **“How do you think bias in social media today could affect future generations understanding of current events?”**

A large, empty rounded rectangular box with a black border, intended for a student to write their reflection on the provided question.



## **ANSWER KEYS**

### **Formative Assessment**

1. O
2. L
3. C
4. A
5. E
6. H
7. D
8. B
9. N
10. F
11. M
12. J
13. G
14. K
15. I

### **SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT**

(ANY ANSWER FROM THE STUDENT IS ADMITTED)

#### **Activity 1**

1. F
2. F
3. S
4. S
5. S

#### **ACTIVITY 2**

1. T
2. T
3. F
4. F

#### **ACTIVITY 3**

1. F
2. T
3. T
4. T

#### ACTIVITY 4

1. C
2. A
3. B
4. C
5. A

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